

TPM Academy — Glossary & Acronyms

A single reference for every acronym and shorthand used across the decks, labs, handouts, and knowledge checks. Grouped by area; the week where each is introduced is noted where useful.

The artifact chain (the backbone of the course)

Each week produces one document; together they're the TPM's integrated spec. Weeks 3–7 build them by hand, Week 8 produces a compressed set with AI.

Acronym	Full name	What it is
PRD	Product Requirements Document	The <i>what</i> and <i>why</i> — problem, users, scope, acceptance criteria (Week 3)
TCD	Technical Concept Document	Architecture, security, components, SLOs, trade-offs (Week 4)
TMD	Technical Modeling Document	Data model, cloud infra, APIs, sequences, monitoring (Week 5)
SEP	Stakeholder Engagement Plan	Stakeholder map, engagement plan, negotiated outcomes (Week 6)
DP	Delivery Plan	Outcomes, ADO setup, tracking, value-stream, bottlenecks (Week 7)
AI Spec	AI-Generated Technical Spec	The integrated spec that ties the artifact set together (Week 8)

"-light" versions (PRD-light, TCD-light, etc.) are the 2-page compressed forms produced in the Week 8 capstone.

Roles & people

Acronym	Meaning
TPM	Technical Product Manager — the role this academy trains
PM	Product Manager
EM	Engineering Manager
CEO / CFO / GM / VP	Chief Executive / Chief Financial Officer / General Manager / Vice President
CS / CSM	Customer Success / Customer Success Manager
GTM	Go-To-Market (sales/marketing motion)

Weeks 1–2 — Customer discovery, metrics, design

Acronym	Full name	Meaning
RCCF	Role, Context, Constraints, Format	The core AI-prompting scaffold
PR/FAQ	Press Release / Frequently Asked Questions	Amazon "Working Backwards" artifact (Day 2)
JTBD	Jobs To Be Done	The progress a customer is trying to make (Day 3)
NS	North Star (metric)	The one metric that best captures customer value (Week 2)
KPI	Key Performance Indicator	A supporting metric that ladders to the North Star
UX	User Experience	
a11y	Accessibility	Numeronym: "a" + 11 letters + "y"
WCAG	Web Content Accessibility Guidelines	The accessibility standard behind the a11y floor
VoC	Voice of Customer	Raw customer input (e.g., the Slack export in the Week-2 research pack)

Evidence tiers (used course-wide to tag every claim, strongest → weakest): **Observed** (seen it happen) › **Reported** (someone said it) › **Inferred** (reasoned from other evidence) › **AI-generated** (drafted by AI; must be upgraded before use).

Week 3 — Requirements

Acronym	Full name	Meaning
AC	Acceptance Criteria	Given/When/Then conditions that define "done"
NFR	Non-Functional Requirement	Performance, security, accessibility, compliance requirements

Week 4 — Architecture, security, reliability

Acronym	Full name	Meaning
C4	Context, Container, Component, Code	The 4-level architecture-diagram model (TPMs draw Context + Container)
STRIDE	Spoofing, Tampering, Repudiation, Information disclosure, Denial of service, Elevation of privilege	Threat-modeling checklist
SLO	Service Level Objective	Internal reliability target (e.g., $p_{95} \leq 400$ ms)
SLA	Service Level Agreement	Contractual commitment with consequences
SLI	Service Level Indicator	The actual measurement behind an SLO
SOC 2	System & Organization Controls 2	Security/compliance audit framework
PCI	Payment Card Industry (Data Security Standard)	Card-handling compliance
PII	Personally Identifiable Information	
CCPA	California Consumer Privacy Act	Privacy regulation
SSO	Single Sign-On	
TLS	Transport Layer Security	Encryption in transit
p95 / p99	95th / 99th percentile	Latency measured at a percentile, not an average

Week 5 — Data, cloud, APIs, modeling

Acronym	Full name	Meaning
API	Application Programming Interface	
REST	Representational State Transfer	Resource-oriented API (URLs are nouns)
SOAP	Simple Object Access Protocol	Older, contract-heavy
HTTP	HyperText Transfer Protocol	Methods: GET/POST/PUT/PATCH
PK / FK	Primary Key / Foreign Key	Database keys
UUID	Universally Unique Identifier	
URL	Uniform Resource Locator	
AZ	Availability Zone	Cloud isolation boundary region
Azure DB for PostgreSQL	Azure Database for PostgreSQL	Managed SQL database
Blob	Azure Blob Storage	Object storage
Event Hubs	Azure Event Hubs	Managed event stream
Cosmos DB	Azure Cosmos DB	Managed NoSQL (key-value/document) store
App GW / GW	Azure Application Gateway / (API) Gateway	Traffic entry points
Service Bus	Azure Service Bus	Managed queues (queues/topics (pub/sub))
Azure Monitor	Azure Monitor	Metrics, logs, and alerts
AKS	Azure Kubernetes Service	Managed Kubernetes
DLQ	Dead-Letter Queue	Where failed messages end up
ROM	Rough Order of Magnitude	Ballpark cost estimate
VPN	Virtual Private Network	

Acronym	Full name	Meaning
RTT	Round-Trip Time	Network latency for a request+response
HTTP status	400/401/403/404/409/422/429	Bad request / unauthenticated / forbidden / not found / unprocessable / rate-

Week 6 — Stakeholders & negotiation

Acronym	Full name	Meaning
SEP	Stakeholder Engagement Plan	The Week-6 artifact
RACI	Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, Informed	Decision-rights matrix (exactly one Accountable)

Week 7 — Agile delivery & Azure DevOps

Acronym	Full name	Meaning
DP	Delivery Plan	The Week-7 artifact
ADO	Azure DevOps	The work-tracking platform
WIQL	Work Item Query Language	ADO's query language for saved queries
VSM	Value Stream Mapping	Lean technique for finding delivery waste
PT / LT	Process Time / Lead Time	Time working vs. total elapsed time (flow efficiency = PT/LT)
WIP	Work In Progress	
ToC	Theory of Constraints	One bottleneck governs system throughput (Goldratt)
CFD	Cumulative Flow Diagram	Chart of work states over time

Week 8 — AI spec & capstone

Acronym	Meaning
AI	Artificial Intelligence
AI Spec	The integrated, AI-drafted technical spec (validated section by section)

Capstone subject is **Holocron** — an enterprise string-management problem supplied as a brief; every quad writes its own requirements from it.

The running case study

Term	Meaning
FieldPulse	The fictional case-study product: a mobile-first field-service dispatch SaaS for HVAC/plumbing/electrical shops with 50–200 technicians
HVAC	Heating, Ventilation & Air Conditioning
ARR	Annual Recurring Revenue (FieldPulse: ~\$40M)
End-of-Day Reconcile	FieldPulse's signature feature idea — close out the day in ~5 min instead of ~45
SaaS	Software as a Service

Assessment & document shorthand

Shorthand	Meaning
MC	Multiple Choice (knowledge-check question)
T/F	True / False (knowledge-check question)
TBD	To Be Determined